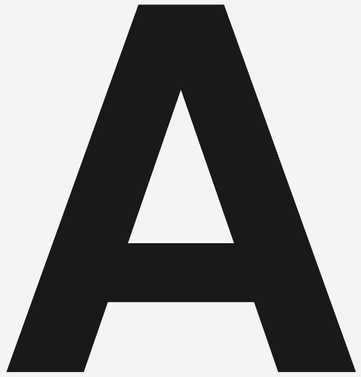
Fall 2026



same information, different experience

When is the same information
no longer the same experience?

Graduate Technology Studio B

Transform
A → A′

01 **INFORMATION CAN SURVIVE A CHANGE IN FORM.**

Information can be represented through different physical states while preserving the pattern that matters.

— Max Tegmark
Life 3.0, Ch. 2 (2018)

02 INFORMATION ✓
MEANING?
EXPERIENCE?

Recontextualize

Same **A**.
Different
context.

REUSE / REARRANGE / RECONTEXTUALIZE

[A] — neutral container
WARNING: A — threat
I ♥ A — affection
DELETE A — erasure

The information does not necessarily have to change for its meaning to change.

Alex Liebergesell, Technology, Design, and Convergence (2015).
Brandon Bauer, To Open […] To Collect […] To Expand […] To Continue (2012).

ASSOCIATE

SAME INFORMATION ≠ SAME ASSOCIATIONS

A single piece of information can branch into:

MEMORY
IMAGE
PERSON
PLACE
EXPERIENCE

Different receivers can follow different associative trails.

"The human mind…operates by association"

Association shapes how information is retrieved and encountered.

Vannevar Bush, As We May Think (1945).

Same Song.

01

STUDIO RECORDING
→ LIVE PERFORMANCE
→ PHONE RECORDING
→ PHOTOGRAPH
→ WRITTEN DESCRIPTION
→ MEMORY
Same song. Different form.

02

WHAT SURVIVED?
Identity
Reference
Recognition

WHAT CHANGED?
Sound
Scale
Duration
Presence
Memory



The Receiver



A → [PERSON 01] → A′

Context / Memory / Attention / Association / Experience

SAME INPUT. DIFFERENT OUTPUT



A → [PERSON 02] → A″

Context / Memory / Attention / Association / Experience

THE RECEIVER IS PART OF THE TRANSFORMATION

COMBINE

A+B / A+C / B+C / C+A / A+B+C

COMBINE / GENERATE / SELECT / INTERPRET

Transformation creates possibility.
Not meaning automatically.

Llull's system can generate combinations systematically, but Borges questions whether combination alone constitutes thought or meaningful understanding.

Jorge Luis Borges, Ramón Llull.s Thinking Machine

A → AI → A′

BEFORE

“Kindly do the needful and revert back at the earliest.”

INFORMATION ✓
VOICE ✓
CULTURE ✓
STYLE ✓

→ AI →

AFTER

“Please take the necessary action and respond as soon as possible.”

INFORMATION ✓
VOICE ?
CULTURE ?
STYLE ?

Preserving what something says does not necessarily preserve how it means.
— David Shariatmadari, "How AI Is Changing Language, July 4, 2026.

A = A?

SAME INFORMATION? Probably.
SAME EXPERIENCE? Not necessarily.

Transformation is not simply a change of form.
Meaning and experience can be reconstructed through context, association, interpretation, and memory.

So what does it actually mean for information to remain “the same”?

CONTEXT / MEMORY / ASSOCIATION / CULTURE / FORM / INTERPRETATION / EXPERIENCE